

Advanced Probabilistic Machine Learning

Ralf Herbrich, Rainer Schlosser

Exact Inference

Overview

1. Factor Graphs
2. Marginalization by Importance Sampling
3. Marginalization by the Sum-Product Algorithm
4. Practical Considerations in Message Passing
5. Application: Bayesian Regression

Overview

1. **Factor Graphs**
2. Marginalization by Importance Sampling
3. Marginalization by the Sum-Product Algorithm
4. Practical Considerations in Message Passing
5. Application: Bayesian Regression

Inference in Probabilistic Models

- **Inference:** In order to learn from data D we follow a three-step procedure

1. **Modelling:** Formulate a joint model $p(\theta, D)$ of parameters $\theta = \theta_1, \dots, \theta_n$ and data D
2. **Conditioning:** Clamp the variables that represent data D (as they are observed)
3. **Marginalize:** **Sum-out** all variables that we are not interested in (latent parameters)

- **Example:** Two player game with one winner

1. **Modelling:** Parameters $\theta = (s_1, s_2, p_1, p_2)$ are skills and performances; data is $y \in \{-1, +1\}$

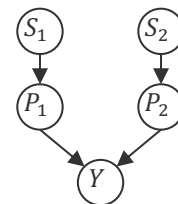
$$p(s_1, s_2, p_1, p_2, y) = \mathcal{N}(s_1; \mu_1, \sigma_1^2) \cdot \mathcal{N}(s_2; \mu_2, \sigma_2^2) \cdot \mathcal{N}(p_1; s_1, \beta^2) \cdot \mathcal{N}(p_2; s_2, \beta^2) \cdot \mathbb{I}(y(p_1 - p_2) > 0)$$

2. **Conditioning:** Player 1 wins ($y = 1$)

$$p(s_1, s_2, p_1, p_2 | y = 1) \propto \mathcal{N}(s_1; \mu_1, \sigma_1^2) \cdot \mathcal{N}(s_2; \mu_2, \sigma_2^2) \cdot \mathcal{N}(p_1; s_1, \beta^2) \cdot \mathcal{N}(p_2; s_2, \beta^2) \cdot \mathbb{I}(p_1 - p_2 > 0)$$

3. **Marginalize:** We are only interested in the skills and need to **sum-out** p_1 and p_2

$$p(s_1, s_2 | y = 1) \propto p(s_1, s_2) \cdot \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} \mathcal{N}(p_1; s_1, \beta^2) \cdot \mathcal{N}(p_2; s_2, \beta^2) \cdot \mathbb{I}(p_1 - p_2 > 0) dp_1 dp_2$$



Factors, Variables and Probabilistic Inference

- **Observation I:** The joint probability model of data and parameters is a *product* of conditional probabilities or clique potentials and has many **factors** with (few) variables!
- **Observation II:** Conditioning does not reduce factors; it removes variables!
- **Problem:** Naïve summation scales exponentially because we have a sum of products (e.g., product of conditional distributions of all latent variables)!
 - **Example:** Consider an example of n Bernoulli variables $x_1, \dots, x_n$

$$p(x_1) = \sum_{x_2=0}^1 \sum_{x_3=0}^1 \cdots \sum_{x_n=0}^1 p(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$$

← 2^{n-1} summations

- **Idea:** We exploit the product structure of the probabilistic model of our data and parameters because not every variable depends on all other variables
 - **Example (ctd).** Consider $p(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n) = \prod_i p(x_i)$: then there are only $O(n)$ sums and $n - 1$ sum to one!

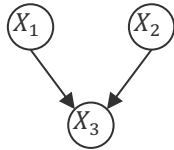
Factor Graphs



Brendan Frey
(1968 –)

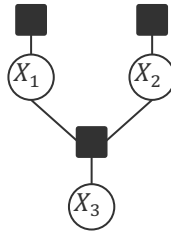
- **Factor Graph (Frey, 1998).** Given a product of m positive functions $f_1, \dots, f_m$, each over a subset of n variables $X_1, X_2, \dots, X_n$, a factor graph is a bipartite graphical model with m factor nodes and n variable nodes where an undirected edge connects f_i and X_j if and only if the function f_i depends on the value of X_j .
- Factor graphs are more expressive than a Bayesian network and Markov random field!

Bayesian network



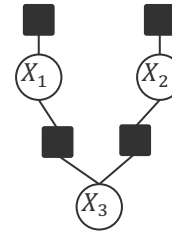
$$p(x_1, x_2, x_3) = p(x_1) \cdot p(x_2) \cdot p(x_3 | x_1, x_2)$$

Corresponding factor graph



$$p(x_1, x_2, x_3) = f_1(x_1) \cdot f_2(x_2) \cdot f_3(x_3, x_1, x_2)$$

Factor graph with more structure



$$p(x_1, x_2, x_3) = f_1(x_1) \cdot f_2(x_2) \cdot f_3(x_1, x_3) \cdot f_4(x_2, x_3)$$

Structure in $p(x_3 | x_1, x_2)$

Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

Overview

1. Factor Graphs
2. **Marginalization by Importance Sampling**
3. Marginalization by the Sum-Product Algorithm
4. Practical Considerations in Message Passing
5. Application: Bayesian Regression

Inference by Importance Sampling

- The key operation is **summing-out** all but one variable (marginalization).
- **Idea:** If we can get J samples $x_{j,1}, \dots, x_{j,n}, j \in \{1, \dots, J\}$ which are drawn according to

$$p(x_1, \dots, x_n) \propto \prod_{i=1}^m f_i(x_1, \dots, x_n)$$

then we can approximate the marginals $p(x_k)$ arbitrarily well via

$$p(x_k) \approx \frac{1}{J} \sum_{j=1}^J \delta(x_k - x_{j,k})$$

- **Challenge:** How do we sample $p(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ if we only have access to (a few) known efficient samplers $q(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ such as (pseudo-random) numbers from the uniform distribution or normal distribution over each X_k ?
- **Importance Sampling:** We get J samples $x_{j,1}, \dots, x_{j,n}, j \in \{1, \dots, J\}$ from $q(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ and re-weight them with

$$\frac{p(x_{j,1}, \dots, x_{j,n})}{q(x_{j,1}, \dots, x_{j,n})}$$

← Importance weight

**Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning**

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

Weighted-Empirical Distribution

- **Weighted Empirical Distribution.** Given a sample $\mathbf{x} = (x_1, \dots, x_n) \in \mathbb{R}^n$ and n coefficients $\mathbf{w} = (w_1, \dots, w_n) \in \mathbb{R}^{+n}$, a random variable $X \in \mathbb{R}$ is said to have the weighted empirical distribution $\mathcal{E}(\cdot; \mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w})$ if the density is

$$p(x; \mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w}) = \frac{1}{Z} \cdot \sum_{i=1}^n w_i \cdot \delta(x - x_i) ,$$

$$Z := \sum_{j=1}^n w_j$$

Normalization constant
so that $1/Z \cdot \sum_{i=1}^n w_i = 1$

- **Cumulative Distribution Function.** Let $X \sim \mathcal{E}(\cdot; \mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w})$ be distributed according to the weighted empirical distribution. Then the cumulative distribution is given by

$$\int_{-\infty}^t \mathcal{E}(x; \mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w}) dx = \frac{1}{Z} \cdot \sum_{i=1}^n w_i \cdot \mathbb{I}(x_i \leq t)$$

Counting all samples
that are smaller than t
weighing each by $1/Z \cdot w_i$

- **Moments.** Let $X \sim \mathcal{E}(\cdot; \mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w})$ be distributed according to the weighted empirical distribution. Then we have for the k -th moment $E[X^k]$

$$E[X^k] = \frac{1}{Z} \cdot \sum_{i=1}^n w_i \cdot x_i^k$$

Weighted sample
averages

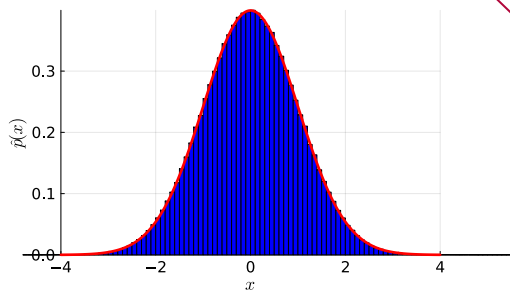
Importance Sampling in Pictures

```
function plot_importance_sampling(p, q; n=100000)
    xs = rand(q, n)
    ws = pdf(p, xs) ./ pdf(q, xs)
    p = histogram(
        xs,
        weights=ws,
        normalize = :pdf,
    )
    xlabel!(L"x")
    ylabel!(L"\hat{p}(x)")
    display(p)
end
```

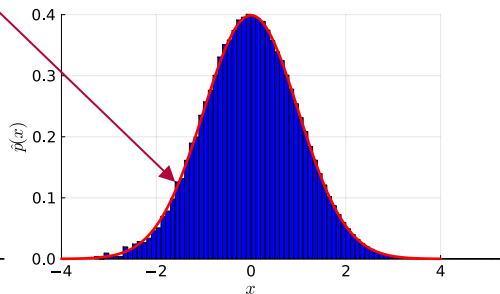
$$p(x) = \mathcal{N}(x; 0, 1)$$

Too little weight in
the proposal

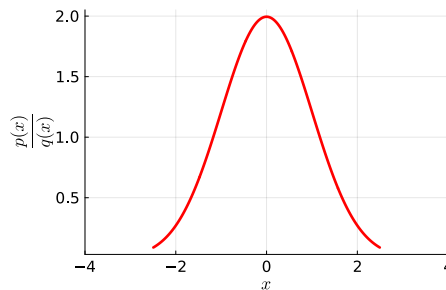
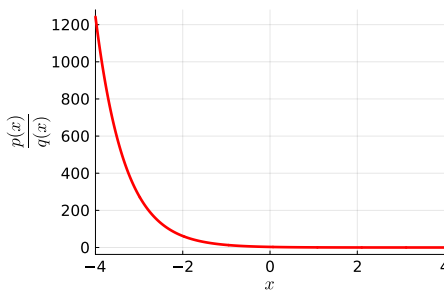
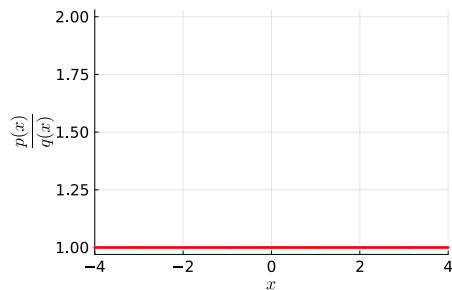
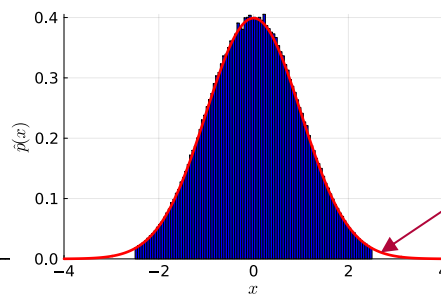
$$q(x) = \mathcal{N}(x; 0, 1)$$



$$q(x) = \mathcal{N}(x; 1.5, 1)$$



$$q(x) = \mathcal{U}(x; -2.5, 2.5)$$



**Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning**

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

Marginalization by Sampling a Factor Graph

Importance Sampling

Given: Proposal distributions $q_1(\cdot), \dots, q_n(\cdot)$ for $X_1, \dots, X_n$

For $j \in \{1, \dots, J\}$

1. Sample $x_{j,1} \sim q_1, x_{j,2} \sim q_2$ up to $x_{j,n} \sim q_n$ into $\mathbf{x}_j = (x_{j,1}, \dots, x_{j,n})$
2. Compute

$$w_j = \prod_{i=1}^m f_i(x_{j,1}, \dots, x_{j,n}) / \prod_{k=1}^n q_k(x_{j,k})$$

Return: $\{\mathbf{x}_j\} \in \mathbb{R}^{J \times n}$ and $\mathbf{w} \in \mathbb{R}^{+J}$ as weighted empirical distribution

■ Pros

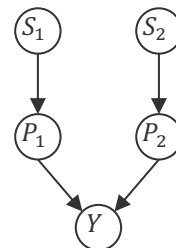
1. Sampling of the $\mathbf{x}_j$ is parallel rather than sequential (as in a Bayesian network)!
2. The weights can also be computed in parallel!

■ Cons

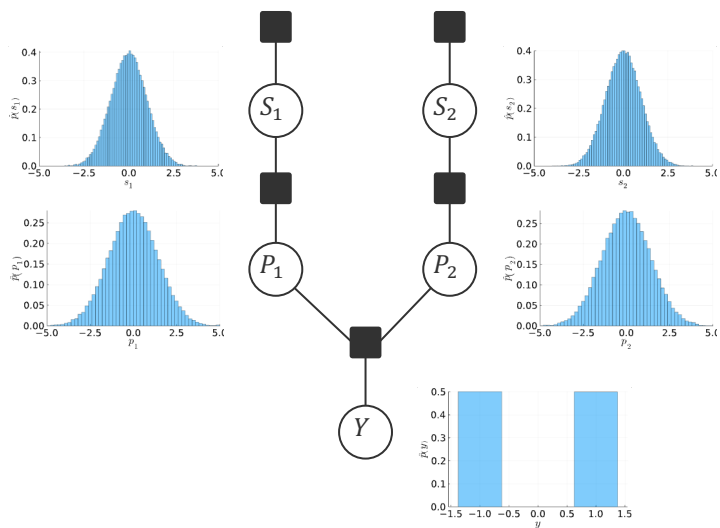
1. If the proposal $\prod_{k=1}^n q_k(\cdot)$ is far from the marginal of $\prod_{i=1}^m f_i(\cdot, \dots, \cdot)$ then convergence is slow

Marginalization by Sampling a Factor Graph: Example

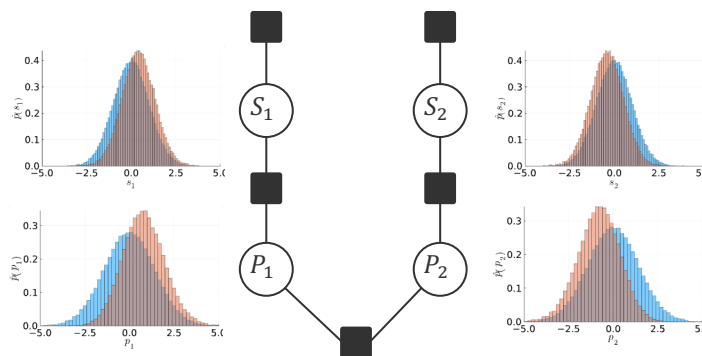
$$\mathcal{N}(s_1; \mu_1, \sigma_1^2) \cdot \mathcal{N}(s_2; \mu_2, \sigma_2^2) \cdot \mathcal{N}(p_1; s_1, \beta^2) \cdot \mathcal{N}(p_2; s_2, \beta^2) \cdot \mathbb{I}(y(p_1 - p_2) > 0)$$



Without match outcome



With match outcome ($y = 1$)



**Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning**

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

Marginalization by Sampling: Image Denoising Example

- **Conditional Ising Model:** Given a two-color image $y_{i,j} \in \{-1, +1\}$ it is a model for the true color $x_{i,j} \in \{-1, +1\}$ by

$$p(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{y}) \propto \exp \left(\sum_{i=1}^L \sum_{j=1}^L \left[h \cdot x_{i,j} \cdot y_{i,j} + \sum_{(i',j') \in \mathcal{N}(i,j)} J \cdot x_{i,j} \cdot x_{i',j'} \right] \right)$$

Coupling strength that a pixel has the same label as its neighbours

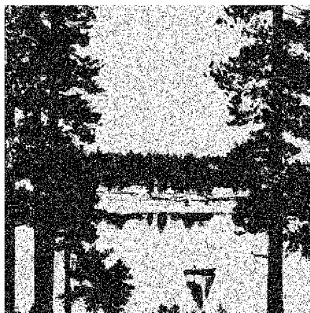
With zero coupling, $h = \frac{1}{2} \cdot \log \left(\frac{p(x_{i,j}=y_{i,j})}{1-p(x_{i,j}=y_{i,j})} \right)$

- It defines a distribution over images $\mathbf{x}$ that only differ from $\mathbf{y}$ by a few pixels parameterized via h : Large h are no differences and as $h \rightarrow 0$, the fraction converges to 100%

$h = 10, J = 0$ ($\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{y}$)



$h = 1, J = 0$



$h = 1, J = 2$



Advanced Probabilistic Machine Learning

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

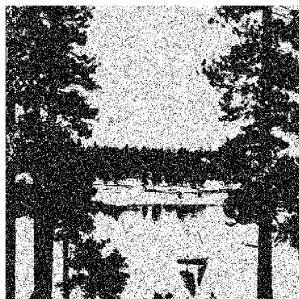
Marginalization by Sampling: Image Denoising Example (ctd)

- **Proposal distribution:** Choose $q(x|y) = p(x|y)$ and use Gibbs sampling
 - Then, the weight w_j of each sample is 1 and the importance sampling is just averaging
 - In practice, more data-efficient samplers are used (Markov-Chain Monte Carlo sampler)
- Each marginal $p(x_{i,j})$ is the fraction of Gibbs samples where the pixel is on
- For $J > 0$ the model encodes the smoothness assumptions of areas on the image!

Original y



With noise y'



$E[X|y']$



Overview

1. Factor Graphs
2. Marginalization by Importance Sampling
- 3. Marginalization by the Sum-Product Algorithm**
4. Practical Considerations in Message Passing
5. Application: Bayesian Regression

Marginalization using the Distributive Law

- **Observation 1:** The **marginal** of a factor graph is a **sum** (over all values of all hidden variables) of a **product** (of factor functions).

$$p(x_1) = \sum_{x_2=0}^1 \sum_{x_3=0}^1 \cdots \sum_{x_n=0}^1 f_1(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n) \cdot \cdots \cdot f_m(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$$

- **Observation 2:** Turning a sum of products *with a common factor* into a product of sums using the *distributive law* saves computation!

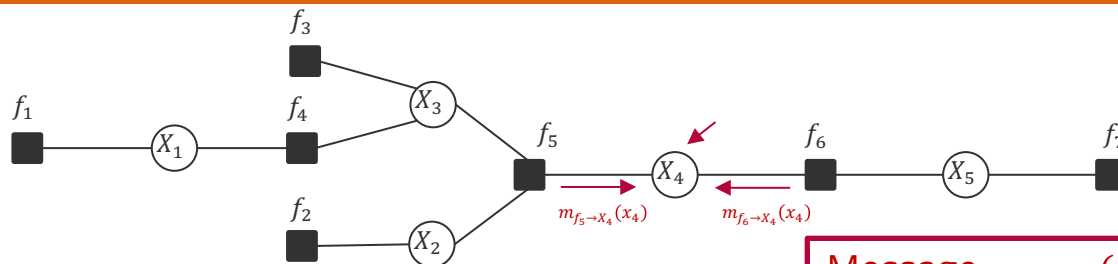
$$a \cdot b + a \cdot c = a \cdot (b + c)$$

3 operations

2 operations

- **Observation 3:** In a typical factor graph, functions only depend on a small number of variables.

Sum-Product Algorithm: Non-normalized Marginals



Message $m_{f_j \rightarrow X_i}(x_i)$ is the sum over all variables in the subtree rooted at f_j with $X_i = x_i$

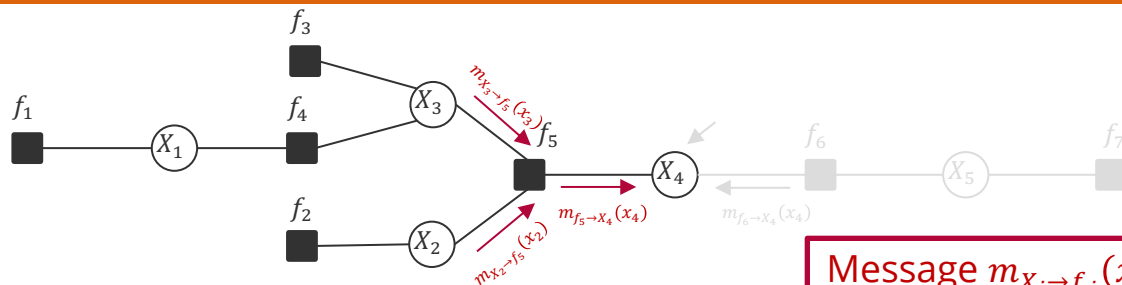
$$\begin{aligned}
 p_{X_4}(x_4) &= \sum_{\{x_1\}} \sum_{\{x_2\}} \sum_{\{x_3\}} \sum_{\{x_5\}} f_1(x_1) \cdot f_2(x_2) \cdot f_3(x_3) \cdot f_4(x_1, x_3) \cdot f_5(x_2, x_3, x_4) \cdot f_6(x_4, x_5) \cdot f_7(x_5) \\
 &= \left[\sum_{\{x_1\}} \sum_{\{x_2\}} \sum_{\{x_3\}} f_1(x_1) \cdot f_2(x_2) \cdot f_3(x_3) \cdot f_4(x_1, x_3) \cdot f_5(x_2, x_3, x_4) \right] \cdot \left[\sum_{\{x_5\}} f_6(x_4, x_5) \cdot f_7(x_5) \right] \\
 &\quad m_{f_5 \rightarrow X_4}(x_4) \qquad \qquad \qquad m_{f_6 \rightarrow X_4}(x_4)
 \end{aligned}$$

**Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning**

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

Non-normalized Marginals are the product of all incoming messages from neighbouring factors!

Sum-Product Algorithm: Message from Factor to Variable



Message $m_{X_i \rightarrow f_j}(x_i)$ is the sum over all variables in the subtree rooted at X_i with $X_i = x_i$

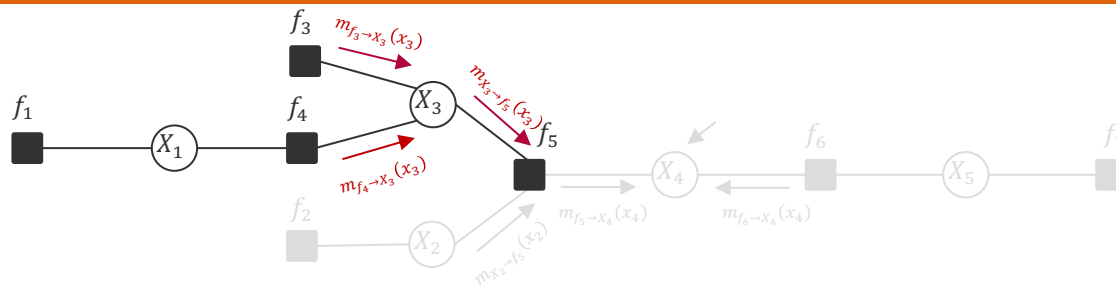
$$\begin{aligned}
 m_{f_5 \rightarrow X_4}(x_4) &= \sum_{\{x_1\}} \sum_{\{x_2\}} \sum_{\{x_3\}} f_1(x_1) \cdot f_2(x_2) \cdot f_3(x_3) \cdot f_4(x_1, x_3) \cdot f_5(x_2, x_3, x_4) \\
 &= \sum_{\{x_2\}} \sum_{\{x_3\}} f_5(x_2, x_3, x_4) \cdot \underbrace{[f_2(x_2)]}_{m_{X_2 \rightarrow f_5}(x_2)} \cdot \underbrace{\left[\sum_{\{x_1\}} f_1(x_1) \cdot f_3(x_3) \cdot f_4(x_1, x_3) \right]}_{m_{X_3 \rightarrow f_5}(x_3)}
 \end{aligned}$$

**Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning**

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

Messages from a factor to a variable sum out all neighboring variables weighted by their incoming message

Sum-Product Algorithm: Message from Variable to Factor



$$\begin{aligned}
 m_{X_3 \rightarrow f_5}(x_3) &= \sum_{\{x_1\}} f_1(x_1) \cdot f_3(x_3) \cdot f_4(x_1, x_3) \\
 &= \underbrace{[f_3(x_3)]}_{m_{f_3 \rightarrow X_3}(x_3)} \cdot \underbrace{\left[\sum_{\{x_1\}} f_1(x_1) \cdot f_4(x_1, x_3) \right]}_{m_{f_4 \rightarrow X_3}(x_3)}
 \end{aligned}$$

Messages from a variable to a factor multiply incoming message from neighboring factors

Sum-Product Algorithm



Robert McEliece
(1942 – 2019)

- **Sum-Product Algorithm (Aji-McEliece, 1997).** Putting it all together, we have

$$\begin{aligned} p_{X_j}(x_j) &= \prod_{i \in \text{ne}(X_j)} m_{f_i \rightarrow X_j}(x_j) \\ m_{f_i \rightarrow X_j}(x_j) &= \sum_{\{x_{\text{ne}(f_i) \setminus \{j\}}\}} f(x_{\text{ne}(f_i)}) \prod_{k \in \text{ne}(f_i) \setminus \{j\}} m_{X_k \rightarrow f_i}(x_k) \\ m_{X_j \rightarrow f_k}(x_j) &= \prod_{i \in \text{ne}(X_j) \setminus \{k\}} m_{f_i \rightarrow X_j}(x_j) \end{aligned}$$

- **Basis:** Generalized distributive law (which also holds for max-product)
- **Efficiency:** By storing messages, we
 - Only have to compute local summations in $O(2^T)$ where degree $T = \max_f |\text{ne}(f)|!$
 - All marginals can be computed recursively in $O(E \cdot 2^T)$ vs $O(2^n)$ (where E is the number of edges of the factor graph)!

**Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning**

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

Overview

1. Factor Graphs
2. Marginalization by Importance Sampling
3. Marginalization by the Sum-Product Algorithm
- 4. Practical Considerations in Message Passing**
5. Application: Bayesian Regression

Even more efficiency

- **Redundancies.** By the very definition of messages and non-normalized marginals

$$p_X(x) = \prod_{i \in \text{ne}(X)} m_{f_i \rightarrow X}(x) = m_{f_k \rightarrow X}(x) \cdot \prod_{i \in \text{ne}(X) \setminus \{k\}} m_{f_i \rightarrow X}(x) \longleftarrow m_{X \rightarrow f_k}(x)$$

- **Interpretation.** Application of Bayes' rule at a variable X at factor f

$$p_X(x) = m_{f \rightarrow X}(x) \cdot m_{X \rightarrow f}(x)$$

non-normalized posterior Likelihood non-normalized prior

- **Storage Efficiency.** We only store the marginals $p_X(x)$ and $m_{f \rightarrow X}(x)$ because

$$m_{X \rightarrow f}(x) = \frac{p_X(x)}{m_{f \rightarrow X}(x)}$$

- **Exponential Family.** If all the messages from factors to variables are in the exponential family, then the marginals and messages from the variable to factors are simply additions and subtraction of natural parameters (up to normalization)!

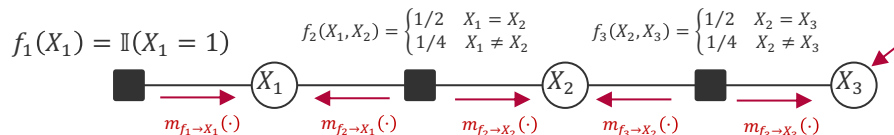
Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

- **Example:** If $p_X(x) = \mathcal{G}(x; \tau_1, \rho_1)$ and $m_{f \rightarrow X}(x) = \mathcal{G}(x; \tau_2, \rho_2)$ then $m_{X \rightarrow f}(x) \propto \mathcal{G}(x; \tau_1 - \tau_2, \rho_1 - \rho_2)$

A Practical Implementation

1. Initialize all messages $m_{f \rightarrow X}(x)$ and marginals $p_X(x)$ with a constant function (i.e., uniform distribution)



2. Pick an arbitrary root (say, X_3)
3. Update all messages $m_{f \rightarrow X}(x)$ from the leaves of the tree rooted at X_3 **upwards**
4. Update all messages $m_{f \rightarrow X}(x)$ from the root X_3 to the leaves **downwards**

Update	$p_{X_1}(\cdot)$	$p_{X_2}(\cdot)$	$p_{X_3}(\cdot)$	$m_{f_1 \rightarrow X_1}(\cdot)$	$m_{f_2 \rightarrow X_1}(\cdot)$	$m_{f_2 \rightarrow X_2}(\cdot)$	$m_{f_3 \rightarrow X_2}(\cdot)$	$m_{f_3 \rightarrow X_3}(\cdot)$
Initial	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$
$m_{f_1 \rightarrow X_1}(\cdot)$	$[1, 0, 0]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$[1, 0, 0]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$
$m_{f_2 \rightarrow X_2}(\cdot)$	$[1, 0, 0]$	$\left[\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{4}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$[1, 0, 0]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{4}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$
$m_{f_3 \rightarrow X_3}(\cdot)$	$[1, 0, 0]$	$\left[\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{4}\right]$	$\left[\frac{3}{8}, \frac{5}{16}, \frac{5}{16}\right]$	$[1, 0, 0]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{4}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{3}{8}, \frac{5}{16}, \frac{5}{16}\right]$
$m_{f_3 \rightarrow X_2}(\cdot)$	$[1, 0, 0]$	$\left[\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{4}\right]$	$\left[\frac{3}{8}, \frac{5}{16}, \frac{5}{16}\right]$	$[1, 0, 0]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{4}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{3}{8}, \frac{5}{16}, \frac{5}{16}\right]$
$m_{f_2 \rightarrow X_1}(\cdot)$	$[1, 0, 0]$	$\left[\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{4}\right]$	$\left[\frac{3}{8}, \frac{5}{16}, \frac{5}{16}\right]$	$[1, 0, 0]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{4}\right]$	$\left[\frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right]$	$\left[\frac{3}{8}, \frac{5}{16}, \frac{5}{16}\right]$

$$m_{f_2 \rightarrow X_2}(x_2) = \sum_{x_1=1}^3 f_2(x_1, x_2) \cdot \frac{p_{X_1}(x_1)}{m_{f_2 \rightarrow X_1}(x_1)} \longleftarrow m_{X_1 \rightarrow f_2}(x_1)$$

Overview

1. Factor Graphs
2. Marginalization by Importance Sampling
3. Marginalization by the Sum-Product Algorithm
4. Practical Considerations in Message Passing
- 5. Application: Bayesian Regression**

Multivariate Normal Distribution

- **Multivariate Normal Distribution.** A continuous random variable $\mathbf{X} \in \mathbb{R}^M$ is said to have a multivariate normal distribution if the density is given by

$$p(\mathbf{x}) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{(2\pi)^M |\boldsymbol{\Sigma}|}} \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu})^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}^{-1}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu})\right)$$

where $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}$ must be a positive definite $M \times M$ matrix and $\boldsymbol{\mu} \in \mathbb{R}^M$.

- **Properties:**

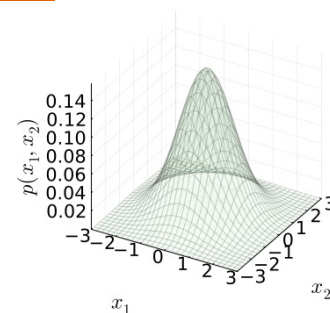
$$E[\mathbf{X}] = \boldsymbol{\mu}$$

$$\text{cov}[\mathbf{X}] = \boldsymbol{\Sigma}$$

- **Covariance.** For any two random variables X_1 and X_2 the covariance expresses the extent to which X_1 and X_2 vary together **linearly** and is given by

$$\text{cov}[X_1, X_2] = E[(X_1 - E[X_1]) \cdot (X_2 - E[X_2])] = E[X_1 X_2] - E[X_1] \cdot E[X_2]$$

- Generalization of the variance to two random variables: $\text{var}[X] = \text{cov}[X, X]$



**Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning**

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

Multivariate Normal Distribution: Representations

■ Two Parameterizations (for different purposes):

□ Scale-Location Parameters

$$\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\mu}, \boldsymbol{\Sigma}) = (2\pi)^{-\frac{M}{2}} |\boldsymbol{\Sigma}|^{-\frac{1}{2}} \cdot \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu})^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}^{-1}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu})\right)$$

$$\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\mu}, \boldsymbol{\Sigma}) = \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\Sigma}^{-1}\boldsymbol{\mu}, \boldsymbol{\Sigma}^{-1})$$

Matrix inverse

□ Natural Parameters

$$\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\tau}, \mathbf{P}) = (2\pi)^{-\frac{M}{2}} |\mathbf{P}|^{\frac{1}{2}} \cdot \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}\boldsymbol{\tau}^T \mathbf{P}^{-1}\boldsymbol{\tau}\right) \cdot \exp\left(\boldsymbol{\tau}^T \mathbf{x} - \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{P} \mathbf{x}\right)$$

$$\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\tau}, \mathbf{P}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{x}; \mathbf{P}^{-1}\boldsymbol{\tau}, \mathbf{P}^{-1})$$

■ Theorem (Multiplication). Given $\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\tau}_1, \mathbf{P}_1)$ and $\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\tau}_2, \mathbf{P}_2)$ we have

$$\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\tau}_1, \mathbf{P}_1) \cdot \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\tau}_2, \mathbf{P}_2) = \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\tau}_1 + \boldsymbol{\tau}_2, \mathbf{P}_1 + \mathbf{P}_2) \cdot \mathcal{N}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_1; \boldsymbol{\mu}_2, \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_1 + \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_2)$$

Additive updates!

Gaussian density

Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

■ Theorem (Division). Given $\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\tau}_1, \mathbf{P}_1)$ and $\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\tau}_2, \mathbf{P}_2)$ where $\mathbf{P}_1 - \mathbf{P}_2 \succcurlyeq 0$

$$\frac{\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\tau}_1, \mathbf{P}_1)}{\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\tau}_2, \mathbf{P}_2)} = \frac{\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{x}; \boldsymbol{\tau}_1 - \boldsymbol{\tau}_2, \mathbf{P}_1 - \mathbf{P}_2)}{\mathcal{N}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_1; \boldsymbol{\mu}_2, \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_2 - \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_1)} \cdot \frac{|\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_2|}{|\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_2 - \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_1|}$$

Subtractive updates!

Correction factor

Gaussian density

Bayesian Inference of Linear Basis Function Models

■ Given:

1. **Training Data:** $D \in (\mathcal{X} \times \mathbb{R})^n$ of n (labelled) examples (x_i, y_i)
2. **Linear Basis Functions:** Basis function mapping $\phi: \mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^M$ and linear function model

$$f(x; \mathbf{w}) := \mathbf{w}^T \phi(x)$$

↖ ↘
weight vector feature vector
3. **Likelihood of functions:**

$$p(D|f) = p(D|\mathbf{w}) = \prod_{i=1}^n \mathcal{N}(y_i; \mathbf{w}^T \phi(x_i), \beta^2)$$

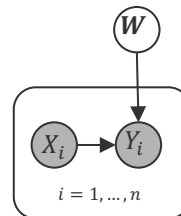
4. **Prior belief over functions:**

$$p(f) = p(\mathbf{w}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{w}; \boldsymbol{\mu}, \boldsymbol{\Sigma})$$

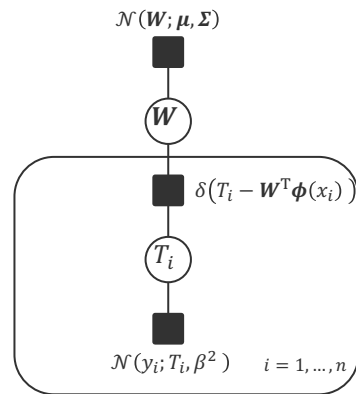
- ## ■ Bayesian Inference: Posterior belief over functions

$$p(f|D) = p(\mathbf{w}|D) \propto \prod_{i=1}^n \mathcal{N}(y_i; \mathbf{w}^T \phi(x_i), \beta^2) \cdot \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{w}; \boldsymbol{\mu}, \boldsymbol{\Sigma})$$

Bayesian Network



Factor Graph

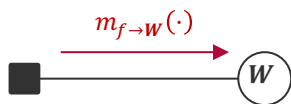


**Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning**

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

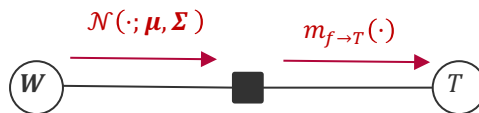
Multivariate Message Update Equations

Gaussian Factor $\mathcal{N}(W; \mu, \Sigma)$



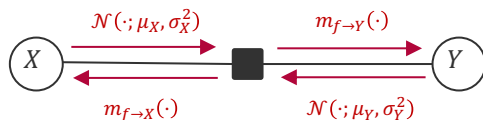
$$m_{f \rightarrow W}(w) = \mathcal{N}(w; \mu, \Sigma)$$

Gaussian Projection Factor $\delta(T - W^T x)$

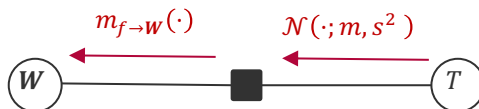


$$m_{f \rightarrow T}(t) = \int \delta(t - w^T x) \cdot \mathcal{N}(w; \mu, \Sigma) dw = \mathcal{N}(t; \mu^T x, x^T \Sigma x)$$

Gaussian Mean Factor $\mathcal{N}(Y; X, \beta^2)$

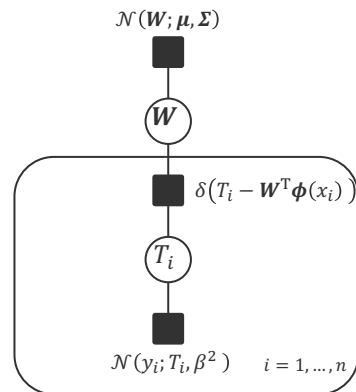


$$\begin{aligned} m_{f \rightarrow Y}(y) &= \mathcal{N}(y; \mu_X, \sigma_X^2 + \beta^2) \\ m_{f \rightarrow X}(x) &= \mathcal{N}(x; \mu_Y, \sigma_Y^2 + \beta^2) \end{aligned}$$



$$m_{f \rightarrow W}(w) = \int \delta(t - w^T x) \cdot \mathcal{N}(t; m, s^2) dt \propto \mathcal{G}\left(w; \frac{m}{s^2} x, \frac{1}{s^2} x x^T\right)$$

Factor Graph



Advanced Probabilistic Machine Learning

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

Bayesian Linear Regression by Message Passing

- **Message:** Simple factor tree where each training example is summarized in an M -dimensional message

- Prior Message $m_{1,0}(\mathbf{w}) = \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{w}; \Sigma^{-1}\boldsymbol{\mu}, \Sigma^{-1}) = p(\mathbf{w})$
- Target Message $m_{2,i}(t_i) = \mathcal{N}(y_i; t_i, \beta^2) = p(y_i|t_i)$
- Data Message $m_{1,i}(\mathbf{w}) = \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{w}; \beta^{-2}y_i\boldsymbol{\phi}(x_i), \beta^{-2}\boldsymbol{\phi}(x_i)\boldsymbol{\phi}^T(x_i)) = p(y_i|\mathbf{w})$

- **Posterior:** Multiplying prior and data messages we have

$$p(\mathbf{w}|D) = \mathcal{G}\left(\mathbf{w}; \Sigma^{-1}\boldsymbol{\mu} + \beta^{-2} \sum_{i=1}^n y_i \boldsymbol{\phi}(x_i), \Sigma^{-1} + \beta^{-2} \sum_{i=1}^n \boldsymbol{\phi}(x_i) \boldsymbol{\phi}^T(x_i)\right)$$

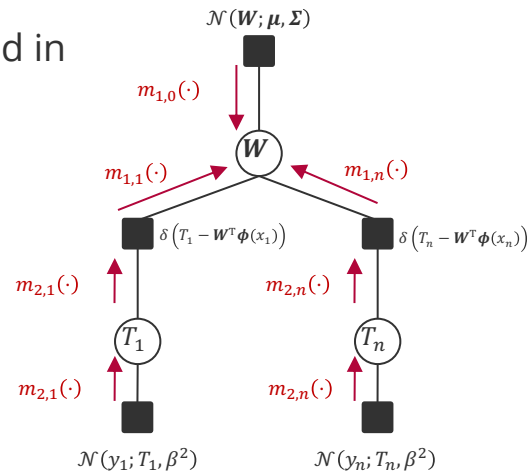
- **Feature Matrix:** All feature vectors are stacked on top of each other in a *feature matrix*

feature vector

$$\Phi = \begin{bmatrix} \phi_1(x_1) & \cdots & \phi_M(x_1) \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \phi_1(x_n) & \cdots & \phi_M(x_n) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \boldsymbol{\phi}^T(x_1) \\ \vdots \\ \boldsymbol{\phi}^T(x_n) \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\Phi^T \mathbf{y} = [\boldsymbol{\phi}(x_1) \quad \cdots \quad \boldsymbol{\phi}(x_n)] \begin{bmatrix} y_1 \\ \vdots \\ y_n \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{i=1}^n y_i \boldsymbol{\phi}(x_i)$$

$$\Phi^T \Phi = [\boldsymbol{\phi}(x_1) \quad \cdots \quad \boldsymbol{\phi}(x_n)] \begin{bmatrix} \boldsymbol{\phi}^T(x_1) \\ \vdots \\ \boldsymbol{\phi}^T(x_n) \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{i=1}^n \boldsymbol{\phi}(x_i) \boldsymbol{\phi}^T(x_i)$$



Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

Bayesian Linear Regression: Training & Prediction

- **Posterior:** In terms of the feature matrix, it can be written as

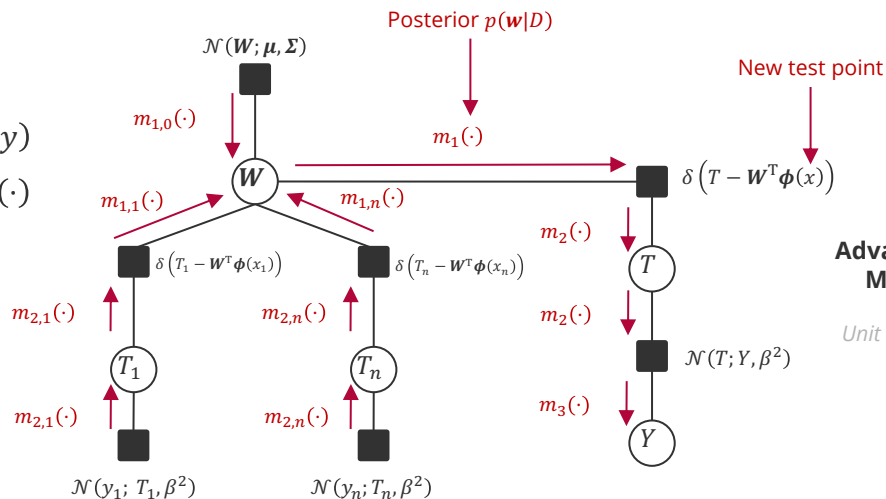
$$p(\mathbf{w}|D) = \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{w}; \Sigma^{-1}\boldsymbol{\mu} + \beta^{-2}\boldsymbol{\Phi}^T\mathbf{y}, \Sigma^{-1} + \beta^{-2}\boldsymbol{\Phi}^T\boldsymbol{\Phi})$$

$$= \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{w}; \mathbf{m}, \mathbf{S})$$

$\mathbf{S}(\Sigma^{-1}\boldsymbol{\mu} + \beta^{-2}\boldsymbol{\Phi}^T\mathbf{y})$ $(\Sigma^{-1} + \beta^{-2}\boldsymbol{\Phi}^T\boldsymbol{\Phi})^{-1}$

- **Data model for prediction:**

- Prediction at new test point x is $m_3(y)$
- Posterior $p(\mathbf{w}|D)$ is the message $m_1(\cdot)$ to the Gaussian projection factor at the test point x
- To avoid recomputing this message for every test point x we simply store the message $m_1(\mathbf{w}) = p(\mathbf{w}|D)$ as the “model”



- **Prediction Tree:** Simple factor chain given posterior $p(\mathbf{w}|D) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{w}; \mathbf{m}, \mathbf{S})$
 - Posterior Message $m_1(\mathbf{w}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{w}; \mathbf{m}, \mathbf{S}) = p(\mathbf{w}|D)$
 - Projection Message $m_2(t) = \mathcal{N}(t; \mathbf{m}^T \boldsymbol{\phi}(x), \boldsymbol{\phi}^T(x) \cdot \mathbf{S} \cdot \boldsymbol{\phi}(x)) = p(t|x, D)$
 - Prediction Message $m_3(y) = \mathcal{N}(y; \mathbf{m}^T \boldsymbol{\phi}(x), \beta^2 + \boldsymbol{\phi}^T(x) \cdot \mathbf{S} \cdot \boldsymbol{\phi}(x)) = p(y|x, D)$
- **Bayesian Linear Regression in Matrix Notation**

Training

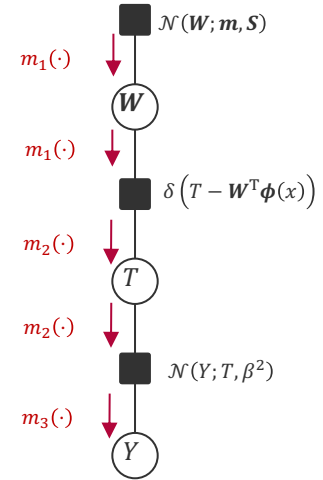
$$\mathbf{S} = (\boldsymbol{\Sigma}^{-1} + \beta^{-2} \boldsymbol{\Phi}^T \boldsymbol{\Phi})^{-1}$$
$$\mathbf{m} = \mathbf{S} \cdot (\boldsymbol{\Sigma}^{-1} \boldsymbol{\mu} + \beta^{-2} \boldsymbol{\Phi}^T \mathbf{y})$$

Prediction

$$p(y|x, D) = \mathcal{N}(y; \mathbf{m}^T \boldsymbol{\phi}(x), \beta^2 + \boldsymbol{\phi}^T(x) \cdot \mathbf{S} \cdot \boldsymbol{\phi}(x))$$

data uncertainty

model uncertainty



**Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning**

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

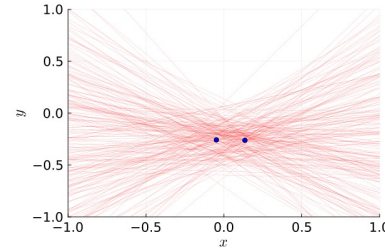
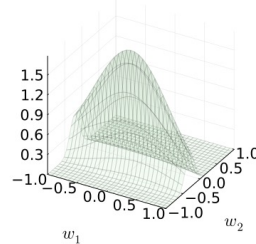
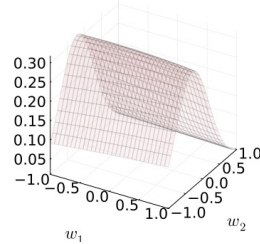
Bayesian Linear Regression: Learning

Likelihood

Posterior

Input Space

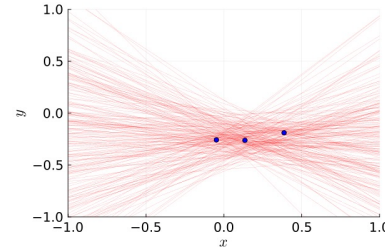
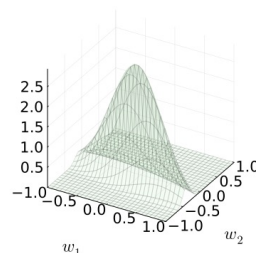
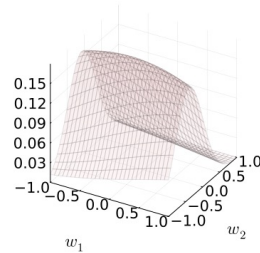
$n = 2$



$$f(x; \mathbf{w}) = w_1 x + w_2$$

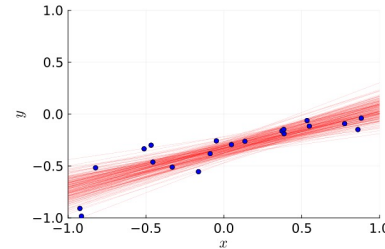
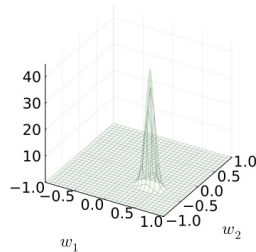
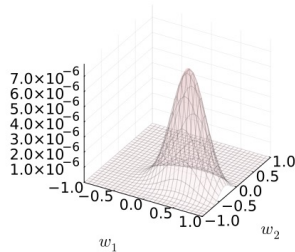
$$p(y|x; \mathbf{w}) = \mathcal{N}(y; f(x), 0.2^2)$$

$n = 3$



$$p(w_j) = \mathcal{N}(w_j; 0, 0.5)$$

$m=20$



**Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning**

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

Bayesian Linear Regression: Learning and Prediction

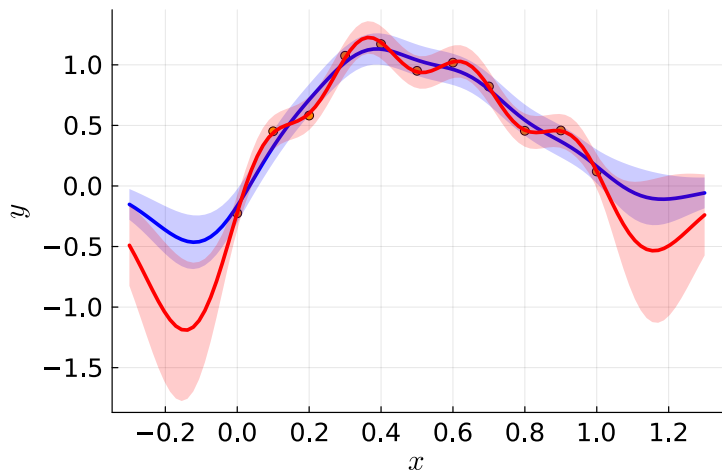
$$p(\mathbf{w}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{w}; \mathbf{0}, \lambda^2 \mathbf{I})$$

$$\lambda = 10$$

$$\lambda = 1$$

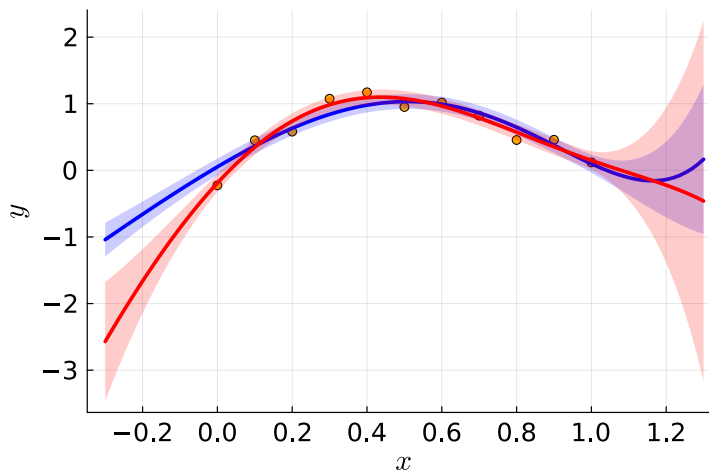
Gaussian Basis

$$\phi_j(x) = \mathcal{N}(x; j, 0.15^2)$$



Polynomial Basis

$$\phi_j(x) = x^j$$



**Advanced Probabilistic
Machine Learning**

Unit 4 – Exact Inference

1. Factor Graphs

- Generalization of graphical models specifically designed for fast and easy inference
- Date back to coding algorithms

2. Marginalization by Importance Sampling

- An easy-to-implement sampling algorithm for the marginal distributions
- Efficiency depends on the “match” of the proposal distributions with marginal distributions

3. Marginalization by the Sum-Product Algorithm

- Application of generalized distributive law which trades memory (“messages”) for computation (“sums”)
- Reduces the computational complexity to exponential in the largest out-degree of a factor!
- There is no faster, exact algorithm for marginalization!

4. Bayesian Linear Regression

- Message passing on the Bayesian Regression factor graph involves no loops and is exact
- For linear basis function models with Normal noise, the posterior can be computed in closed form as a multivariate Gaussian whose variance accounts for model uncertainty

See you next week!